

Promethius

Install & run your own AI on your laptop — Windows, macOS & Linux

What you are installing

Promethius is a local-first AI assistant made of three parts: a **React** frontend, a **FastAPI** (Python) backend, and a **MongoDB** database. Files you upload and media Promethius generates are now stored on your own disk — nothing leaves your machine except calls you choose to make to AI providers.

You have two ways to power the intelligence: **(A) 100% offline with Ollama** (free, runs on your hardware) or **(B) cloud API keys** (Anthropic, ElevenLabs, fal.ai, Tavily, OpenAI) for the most capable models, voice and video. You can mix both.

1 Prerequisites

Install these once. Run the commands for your operating system.

Windows

```
# Install via winget (Windows 10/11)
winget install Git.Git
winget install Python.Python.3.11
winget install OpenJS.NodeJS.LTS
winget install MongoDB.Server
npm install -g yarn
```

macOS

```
# Install Homebrew first if needed: https://brew.sh
brew install git python@3.11 node
brew tap mongodb/brew && brew install mongodb-community
npm install -g yarn
```

Linux (Debian/Ubuntu)

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install -y git python3.11 python3.11-venv python3-pip nodejs npm
# MongoDB: follow https://www.mongodb.com/docs/manual/installation/
sudo npm install -g yarn
```

Verify everything is on your PATH:

```
git --version
python --version # or python3 --version
node --version
yarn --version
mongod --version
```

2 Get the code

```
git clone <YOUR_PROMETHIUS_REPO_URL> promethius
cd promethius
# You should see two folders: backend/ and frontend/
```

Quick start (one command)

Once your two .env files (sections 4 & 7) and prerequisites are in place, the included launcher boots MongoDB + backend + frontend together. Run it from the project root:

```
# macOS / Linux
chmod +x start.sh # first time only
./start.sh

# Windows
start.bat
```

Prefer to do it manually? Follow sections 3-7 below.

3 Start MongoDB

Promethius stores conversations, memory and voiceprints in MongoDB.

Windows

```
# Runs as a service automatically after install. To run manually:
"C:\Program Files\MongoDB\Server\7.0\bin\mongod.exe" --dbpath C:\data\db
```

macOS

```
brew services start mongodb-community
```

Linux

```
sudo systemctl start mongod
```

MongoDB will now be available at **mongodb://localhost:27017**.

4 Configure the backend (backend/.env)

Create a file named **.env** inside the **backend/** folder with the following. Leave a provider key blank to disable that feature.

```
# --- Core (required) ---
MONGO_URL=mongodb://localhost:27017
DB_NAME=promethius
CORS_ORIGINS=http://localhost:3000
JWT_SECRET=change-me-to-a-long-random-string
STORAGE_DIR=./storage # where uploads & generated media are saved

# --- Passkey login (use localhost values for local) ---
WEBAUTHN_RP_ID=localhost
WEBAUTHN_RP_NAME=Promethius
WEBAUTHN_EXPECTED_ORIGIN=http://localhost:3000

# --- Option A: 100% offline with Ollama (free) ---
```

```
OLLAMA_BASE_URL=http://localhost:11434
```

```
# --- Option B: cloud keys (optional, for best quality) ---
ANTHROPIC_API_KEY=          # claude-sonnet-4-6 (recommended chat model)
OPENAI_API_KEY=             # GPT, image gen, Whisper
ELEVENLABS_API_KEY=        # lifelike voice (TTS/STT)
TAVILY_API_KEY=            # web search / deep research
FAL_KEY=                   # text/image-to-video generation
RESEND_API_KEY=            # email recovery codes
SENDER_EMAIL=you@yourdomain.com
```

Where to get the keys:

- Anthropic — console.anthropic.com
- OpenAI — platform.openai.com/api-keys
- ElevenLabs — elevenlabs.io (Profile → API Key)
- Tavily — tavily.com
- fal.ai — fal.ai/dashboard/keys
- Resend — resend.com/api-keys

5 Option A — Run fully offline with Ollama

Skip this section if you only use cloud keys.

Download Ollama from <https://ollama.com/download> (Windows/macOS/Linux), then pull a model:

```
ollama pull llama3.1
# optional alternatives:
ollama pull mistral
ollama pull qwen2.5

# Ollama serves automatically at http://localhost:11434
```

In the app's model selector, choose provider **Ollama** and the model you pulled. No internet or API key required for chat.

Note: voice (ElevenLabs), video (fal.ai) and web search (Tavily) still need their respective cloud keys — they have no offline equivalent.

6 Install & start the backend

Windows (PowerShell)

```
cd backend
python -m venv venv
.\venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1
pip install -r requirements.txt
uvicorn server:app --host 0.0.0.0 --port 8001 --reload
```

macOS / Linux

```
cd backend
python3 -m venv venv
source venv/bin/activate
pip install -r requirements.txt
uvicorn server:app --host 0.0.0.0 --port 8001 --reload
```

The backend is now live at **http://localhost:8001** (health check: <http://localhost:8001/api/>).

7 Configure & start the frontend

Create a file named **.env** inside the **frontend/** folder:

```
REACT_APP_BACKEND_URL=http://localhost:8001
```

Then, in a **second terminal**:

```
cd frontend
yarn install
yarn start
```

Your browser opens at **http://localhost:3000**. The orb appears — tap it to awaken Prometheus.

8 First run

1. On the Auth screen, create your passkey (fingerprint / Face ID / Windows Hello). The first account becomes the admin.
2. Open Settings to choose your AI model (Ollama for offline, or Anthropic/OpenAI).
3. Say "Promethius, this is <your name>" to enroll your voiceprint.
4. Start talking, or say "open the prompt" for the chat workspace.

Troubleshooting

Passkey won't register

Passkeys require **localhost** or HTTPS. Make sure WEBAUTHN_RP_ID=localhost and WEBAUTHN_EXPECTED_ORIGIN=http://localhost:3000 in backend/.env, and that you open the app at http://localhost:3000 (not 127.0.0.1).

“Connection refused” in the UI

The backend isn't running or REACT_APP_BACKEND_URL is wrong. Confirm uvicorn is up on port 8001 and frontend/.env points to it.

MongoDB errors on startup

Ensure mongod is running and MONGO_URL matches (default mongodb://localhost:27017).

Microphone / wake-word not working

Use Google Chrome and allow microphone access. The Web Speech wake-word needs Chrome + a mic.

OpenAI features error out

Either add billing to your OpenAI account or switch the model selector to Anthropic or Ollama. Image generation specifically requires a funded OpenAI key.

That's it — Prometheus now runs entirely on your machine. Bring knowledge like fire. ■